

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 16)

Page 77 - Francis Bacon (Part 2)

Q1. Despite his stated purpose of serving mankind, what did Bacon often sacrifice his ideals for in practice?

- A. The pursuit of pure poetry
- B. Wealth, power, and the satisfaction of his inordinate ambitions
- C. A quiet life in the country
- D. Religious devotion

Answer: B

Q2. What are considered Bacon's greatest works, placing him in the front rank of the world's epoch-makers?

- A. The Faerie Queene and Amoretti
- B. Advancement of Learning and Novum Organum
- C. Utopia and Morte d'Arthur
- D. The Alchemist and Volpone

Answer: B

Q3. What do the Advancement of Learning and Novum Organum belong to the history of?

- A. Science and philosophy (they illustrate the inductive method of studying nature)
- B. Dramatic poetry
- C. Religious allegory
- D. Fictional romance

Answer: A

Q4. What is Francis Bacon's principal contribution to general literature?

- A. A massive epic poem
- B. His little collection of Essays (or Counsels Civil and Moral)
- C. A dictionary of the English language
- D. A translation of the Bible

Answer: B

Q5. The writing of Bacon's Essays was doubtless suggested by the 'Essais' of which great French thinker?

- A. Voltaire
- B. Montaigne

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C. Rousseau

D. Descartes

Answer: B

Q6. How did Bacon use the word 'essay' (in its original etymological sense)?

A. As a long, exhaustive treatise

B. As equivalent to 'assay' - a trial or attempt (informal thoughts)

C. As a rhyming poem

D. As a dramatic script

Answer: B

Q7. What are the salient qualities of Bacon's Essays?

A. Extreme emotionalism and lack of logic

B. Extraordinary insight and sagacity (loaded with ripest wisdom of experience)

C. Deep religious mysticism

D. Complete historical inaccuracy

Answer: B

Q8. The wisdom inculcated in Bacon's Essays is on the whole of what kind?

A. A distinctly worldly kind

B. A purely spiritual kind

C. A naive, childish kind

D. A romantic kind

Answer: A

Q9. How is Bacon's prose style described despite his supposed aim for 'masculine and clear expression'?

A. Completely plain and without metaphor

B. Marked by general ornateness, fondness for imagery, love of analogy, and highly Latinised

C. Written entirely in rhyming couplets

D. Written in French

Answer: B

Q10. What is the most important characteristic of Bacon's style, giving it the description 'infinite riches in a

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little room'?

- A. Its extreme length
- B. Its marvellous terseness and epigrammatic force (packing thoughts into small spaces)
- C. Its musical rhythm
- D. Its use of dialogue

Answer: B

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Page 78 - Other Prose of the Period & Tables

Q1. Who wrote the vast and uncritical 'History of the World' (1614)?

- A. Francis Bacon
- B. Sir Walter Raleigh
- C. John Foxe
- D. Raphael Holinshed

Answer: B

Q2. Who wrote the 'History of the Reign of Henry VII' (1622)?

- A. William Shakespeare
- B. Francis Bacon
- C. Raphael Holinshed
- D. Richard Hakluyt

Answer: B

Q3. What is John Foxe known for writing in 1563?

- A. Chronicles of England
- B. Acts and Monuments (or Book of Martyrs)
- C. Ecclesiastical Polity
- D. The Faerie Queene

Answer: B

Q4. Which historical work did Shakespeare often lay under contribution for his historical plays?

- A. Raleigh's History of the World
- B. Holinshed's Chronicles of England, Scotland, and Ireland
- C. Foxe's Book of Martyrs
- D. Hakluyt's Voyages

Answer: B

Q5. Which famous work is an example of the literature of travel that flourished during this time of adventure?

- A. Bacon's Essays
- B. Richard Hakluyt's Principal Navigations, Voyages, Traffiques, and Discoveries

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C. Sidney's Arcadia

D. More's Utopia

Answer: B

Q6. Who wrote the masterly 'Ecclesiastical Polity' (1594-97), noted for a style generally plainer than most contemporary prose?

A. Richard Hooker

B. Francis Bacon

C. John Donne

D. Thomas Cranmer

Answer: A

Q7. What profoundly influential religious text was published in 1611?

A. The Book of Common Prayer

B. The Authorised Version of the Bible

C. The 95 Theses

D. The Vulgate

Answer: B

Q8. What does the development of the literature of criticism during this era signify?

A. That people were losing interest in reading

B. That people were beginning to be interested in the forms and principles of literature as an art

C. That poetry was being outlawed

D. That only prose was now accepted

Answer: B

Q9. What is the best known of these early treatises of criticism, written about 1581?

A. Sidney's Apologie for Poetrie

B. Webbe's Discourse of English Poetrie

C. Puttenham's Arte of English Poesie

D. Bacon's Novum Organum

Answer: A

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Q10. According to the Table, when was the first English comedy in prose (Gascoigne's Supposes) published?

A. 1558

B. 1561

C. 1566

D. 1576

Answer: C

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Page 79 - Tables of the Age of Shakespeare (Part 1)

Q1. According to the table, what event occurred in 1576 under the Drama column?

- A. Shakespeare was born
- B. First London playhouses built
- C. The Globe Theatre was built
- D. The theatres were closed

Answer: B

Q2. In what year was Gascoigne's 'Steele Glas' published?

- A. 1559
- B. 1566
- C. 1576
- D. 1579

Answer: C

Q3. In what year were Holinshed's Chronicles published?

- A. 1563
- B. 1570
- C. 1577
- D. 1581

Answer: C

Q4. The 'Later Elizabethan Period' spans from 1579 to what year?

- A. 1588
- B. 1593
- C. 1603
- D. 1625

Answer: C

Q5. Which three major works were all published in 1579, marking the start of the Later Elizabethan Period?

- A. Hamlet, Macbeth, King Lear
- B. The Shepheardes Calender, Lyly's first comedy Endymion, and Lyly's Euphues

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C. Faery Queene, Arcadia, Astrophel

D. Gorboduc, Roister Doister, Four Ps

Answer: B

Q6. According to the table, when were Sidney's Arcadia and Apologie for Poetrie written?

A. About 1570

B. About 1581

C. About 1590

D. About 1603

Answer: B

Q7. When did Christopher Marlowe write his first tragedy, Tamburlaine the Great?

A. 1579

B. 1587

C. 1593

D. 1600

Answer: B

Q8. What years span Shakespeare's First Period according to the table?

A. 1579-1588

B. 1588-1593

C. 1594-1600

D. 1601-1608

Answer: B

Q9. Who wrote 'Pandosto' in 1588, which later became source material for Shakespeare?

A. Thomas Lodge

B. Robert Greene

C. Thomas Nash

D. John Lyly

Answer: B

Q10. Who wrote the 'Discourse of English Poetrie' in 1586?

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- A. George Puttenham
- B. William Webbe
- C. Philip Sidney
- D. Francis Bacon

Answer: B

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Page 80 - Tables of the Age of Shakespeare (Part 2)

Q1. In what year were the first three books of Spenser's Faery Queene published?

- A. 1586
- B. 1590
- C. 1596
- D. 1599

Answer: B

Q2. What significant event in the dramatic world happened in 1593?

- A. Shakespeare was born
- B. The Globe was built
- C. The Death of Marlowe
- D. The theatres were closed

Answer: C

Q3. What years cover Shakespeare's Second Period?

- A. 1588-1593
- B. 1594-1600
- C. 1600-1608
- D. 1608-1612

Answer: B

Q4. When was the first edition of Bacon's Essays (containing ten essays) published?

- A. 1588
- B. 1594
- C. 1597
- D. 1603

Answer: C

Q5. What was Ben Jonson's first play, performed in 1598?

- A. The Alchemist
- B. Volpone

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C. Every Man in his Humour

D. Sejanus

Answer: C

Q6. When was the Globe Theatre built?

A. 1576

B. 1588

C. 1599

D. 1616

Answer: C

Q7. What year did Edmund Spenser die?

A. 1593

B. 1599

C. 1603

D. 1616

Answer: B

Q8. What years cover the 'Jacobean Period'?

A. 1558-1603

B. 1579-1603

C. 1603-1625

D. 1625-1649

Answer: C

Q9. Which dramatist died in 1606 during the Jacobean period?

A. Marlowe

B. Shakespeare

C. Lyly

D. Jonson

Answer: C

Q10. When did Beaumont and Fletcher begin producing their plays according to the table?

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A. 1594

B. 1600

C. 1607

D. 1616

Answer: C

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Page 81 - Tables & Notes (Jacobean Period)

Q1. What years span Shakespeare's Fourth Period (his final period of dramatic romances)?

- A. 1594-1600
- B. 1600-1608
- C. 1608-1612
- D. 1612-1616

Answer: C

Q2. In what year were Shakespeare's Sonnets published?

- A. 1594
- B. 1599
- C. 1609
- D. 1623

Answer: C

Q3. What monumental translation was published in 1611?

- A. The English translation of Homer
- B. The Authorised Version of the Bible
- C. The translation of Seneca's tragedies
- D. The English translation of Dante

Answer: B

Q4. When did Shakespeare and Francis Beaumont both die?

- A. 1606
- B. 1612
- C. 1616
- D. 1625

Answer: C

Q5. When was the First Folio of Shakespeare's plays published?

- A. 1616 (the year of his death)
- B. 1623

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C. 1630

D. 1650

Answer: B

Q6. When did John Fletcher die?

A. 1616

B. 1623

C. 1625

D. 1637

Answer: C

Q7. How many essays were in the third edition of Bacon's Essays, published in 1625?

A. 10

B. 25

C. 58

D. 100

Answer: C

Q8. According to the footnote on page 81, what does the Spanish word 'pizarro' mean?

A. A hero

B. A rogue

C. A priest

D. A traveler

Answer: B

Q9. Which author's work 'Polyolbion' spans the dates 1613-1622 in the table?

A. Raleigh

B. Drayton

C. Bacon

D. Webster

Answer: B

Q10. Which period concludes with the deaths of Fletcher and King James I in 1625?

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- A. The Early Elizabethan Period
- B. The Later Elizabethan Period
- C. The Jacobean Period
- D. The Caroline Period

Answer: C